not cut out for the captaincy. It takes managerial skills I admit I don't have. Still, I suppose that doesn't disqualify me from having a firm opinion on what makes a good captain. I have played under enough of them to observe different approaches.

As I said earlier, despite his shortcomings, Hansie Cronjé was the best captain I ever played under. He could tread that fine line between bonding with the team while still maintaining sufficient distance so that he could treat everyone equally. It also allowed him to be hard on an individual when the situation demanded it. Every single one of his players had huge respect for the guy.

Things were never the same after Hansie was banned. I sympathised with Shaun Pollock – he had a tough time filling Hansie's shoes and gluing the team back together at the same time. But the Proteas never had that same togetherness under Polly. He never socialised with the boys too much but, that said, like Hansie, Polly also never got too close to any one player, for which I respected him.

If you ask me, I think the issue really became a problem when Mickey Arthur took over. Mickey wasn't the most forceful personality, and I guess he found it tough to coach guys who had played close to 100 Tests. Too often he bowed to senior players' opinions.

I think he made an effort to take them on once or twice, but he wasn't being taken seriously. Simply put, without Graeme's backing, Mickey didn't have much influence over the guys. In the end, Graeme was simply too powerful. If it was indeed the case that he had wanted Mickey out, as many fans and the press speculated, Mickey would have been asked to leave. Of course, as I was not a member of the inner circle, I wasn't privy to why Graeme might have wanted Mickey out.

New coach Corrie van Zyl has talked about how he wants to mould the Proteas into a proper team, and the new convener of selectors, Andrew Hudson, has also made noises about wielding the big broom. Whether that means dropping some of the senior players and bringing in new blood (and I do realise that Mr Hudson's broom could sweep me out too), or using a very firm hand to set up a new player–coach dynamic, I don't know.

My future in the team

I have simply been honest in my preceding comments. I sincerely hope my colleagues and the Proteas team management see it that way. My intention